

Aristida portoricensis

Pelos del diablo

Family (Poaceae)

Kingdom (Plantae)

Status (Endangered)

Description

A tufted perennial grass with slender culms that can reach 30–50 cm in height. The blades are involute, narrow, and somewhat curved, while the panicles are loose, narrow, and few-flowered. It has awn-pointed glumes, a scabrous lemma with a slightly twisted neck, and three nearly equal awns that are divergent and 2–3 cm long.



Location/Habitat



Found on the upper slopes of the Sierra Bermeja in southwestern Puerto Rico, at elevations of 180–300 meters. It grows in exposed rocky outcrops, crevices, and open areas with shallow, acidic soils derived from siliceous rock, within the subtropical dry forest zone. Surrounding vegetation includes scrub forests with drought-adapted species.